

Whitsundays

What every client should know before visiting the Whitsundays — and what your team should brief them on.

HOW TO USE

Brief clients on the four essentials before departure. The full conduct reference below supports thorough briefings and operator selection.

BRIEF YOUR CLIENT ON THESE FOUR

01 Choose Advanced Eco Certified operators

Cruise Whitsundays and others hold Ecotourism Australia Advanced Eco Certification. Reef fees fund Marine Park management — always book certified operators over uncertified ones.

02 Protect Whitehaven Beach — take nothing, leave nothing

The 98% pure silica sand is internationally rare and fragile. No smoking, no glass, and all rubbish must leave with the visitor — there are no bins. The sand must never be removed.

03 Use reef-safe sunscreen and never touch coral

Standard sunscreens damage coral; TGA-approved reef-safe formulas are essential. Clients must float, never stand on or touch the reef.

04 Respect Ngaro sea Country

The Ngaro, Gia and Juru are the Traditional Owners. Encourage clients to engage respectfully with cultural sites such as Nara Inlet's ancient rock art on Hook Island.

SAFETY-CRITICAL — COMMUNICATE EVERY TIME

In-water safety. Brief clients to wear stinger suits in season (Nov–May), only enter the water with permitted operators, use the buddy system, and attend every crew safety briefing. Marine stingers and currents are genuine risks.

ENCOURAGE

- + Choose Ecotourism Australia certified operators
- + Use reef-safe, TGA-approved sunscreen
- + Take all rubbish off Whitehaven Beach
- + Keep 100m from whales (300m with calves)
- + Use moorings, never anchor on coral
- + Walk part of the Ngaro Sea Trail
- + Wear a stinger suit in season
- + Join Eye on the Reef citizen science

ADVISE AGAINST

- Remove sand from Whitehaven Beach
- Smoke or bring glass onto Whitehaven
- Touch, stand on or kick coral
- Chase, touch or feed marine wildlife
- Discharge rubbish or fuel overboard
- Disturb nesting turtles or their tracks
- Approach whales within 100m
- Buy souvenirs made from reef species

NGARO SEA COUNTRY

The Ngaro, Gia and Juru people are the Traditional Owners of the Whitsunday lands and seas. The Ngaro — a saltwater people — navigated these islands by canoe for thousands of years. Encourage clients to visit the Ngaro Sea Trail and Nara Inlet rock art respectfully.